

Allusion — Venue Rental Platform

Workflows & Use Cases — Executive Overview

The Story Behind This

Allusion has a building with a room that sits empty most of the time. The team uses it once a week and occasionally during lunch breaks, but for the large majority of the week, it is unused. Rather than leaving that space idle, Allusion wants to rent it out during those empty hours and days — generating income from an asset they already own, without creating extra work for the team.

The challenge is doing this in a way that does not become a burden. Nobody at Allusion wants to spend time answering booking emails, chasing payments, writing invoices, or coordinating access manually. The solution is a fully automated rental system powered by modern AI tools and automation, where Allusion's only real job is to briefly review a request and say yes or no. Everything else happens on its own.

The system handles the entire customer journey — from the first booking request to the final confirmation and access — without requiring anyone at Allusion to be actively involved. Customers who do not pay do not get access. Customers who pay and show up at the right time get everything they need. The team is only notified when their input is actually required.

Page 1 — Use Cases

1. A customer wants to rent the room for a day or more A customer finds our booking page, fills in a short form explaining what they need the room for, selects their dates and times, and submits. The system checks availability automatically. If the dates are free, Allusion receives a notification with all the details. The team reviews it briefly — this takes no more than a few minutes — and either approves or declines. From that point on, everything is handled automatically.

2. A customer wants to rent the room for a specific event or purpose Same flow as above. Because the purpose of the rental matters to Allusion, the customer is asked to briefly explain their reason when submitting the form. This gives Allusion the context needed to make a quick and informed decision at the approval step. No meeting is needed in most cases.

3. Allusion wants to have a quick conversation before approving For bookings that feel unusual or require more context, Allusion has the option to request a short meeting with the customer before deciding. This meeting is scheduled automatically and added to both parties' calendars. After the meeting, Allusion approves or declines as normal.

- 4. A customer wants to visit the space before committing** If a customer asks to see the room first, they can request a visit through the same form. The visit is scheduled automatically, and the customer receives a calendar invite. After the visit, the booking process continues normally if they wish to proceed.
- 5. A customer does not pay after approval** If a customer is approved but does not complete payment within the agreed time, they receive automatic reminders. If they still do not pay, the booking is automatically cancelled, the dates are released, and Allusion is notified. No manual follow-up is needed from the team.
- 6. A customer cancels a confirmed booking** If a customer cancels, the system processes it automatically according to Allusion's cancellation policy — sending a confirmation, handling any applicable refund, and making the room available again for new bookings.
- 7. A customer does not show up** Once a booking is confirmed and paid, the responsibility lies entirely with the customer. If they do not show up, that is their own decision. Allusion has already been paid and no action is required from the team.
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Page 2 — End-to-End Workflow

This is the full journey of every booking from first contact to completion. Steps marked with **[Allusion]** are the only moments where a human needs to be involved.

Step 1 — Customer submits a request The customer fills in the online booking form: their name, contact details, the dates they want, the purpose of the rental, and the number of people attending. Submission takes under two minutes.

Step 2 — Availability is checked automatically The system immediately confirms whether the requested dates are free. If not, the customer is informed automatically and offered the next available slot.

Step 3 — Allusion is notified (*automated*) The responsible person at Allusion receives a clear, structured notification with everything they need to make a decision: who is requesting, what for, how many people, and for how long.

Step 4 — Allusion reviews and decides **[Allusion]** This is the first and most important human step. The team reads the request and either approves it, declines it, or requests a brief meeting. This takes a few minutes at most.

Step 5 — Optional: a meeting is scheduled (*automated if triggered*) If Allusion wants to speak with the customer first, a calendar invite is sent automatically to both sides. After the meeting, Allusion returns to step 4.

Step 6 — Customer is notified of the outcome (*automated*) If declined, the customer receives a polite message explaining the decision. If approved, they move to the payment step.

Step 7 — Invoice is generated and sent (*automated*) An invoice is created automatically and sent to the customer with a secure online payment link. No manual invoice writing is needed.

Step 8 — Customer pays (*customer action*) The customer pays by card through the payment link. Until payment is completed, the booking is not confirmed and no access is granted.

Step 9 — Confirmation is sent automatically (*automated*) The moment payment is received, the customer gets a confirmation email and a calendar invite — compatible with Google Calendar, Apple Calendar, or any other standard calendar app — with all the details: date, time, address, access instructions, and any relevant house rules. Allusion receives the same invite in their own calendar so the booking is always visible to the team.

Step 10 — Internal tasks are assigned (*automated*) The person at Allusion responsible for access or preparation receives an automatic notification with the booking details and what they need to do before the rental date.

Step 11 — Reminders are sent (*automated*) The customer receives a reminder 3 days before and again the day before. The operations contact at Allusion also receives a reminder to ensure everything is ready.

Step 12 — Day of the rental **[Allusion — minimal]* The customer arrives at the agreed time and is given access to the room. This is the second and final moment where Allusion needs to be physically present — simply to open the door or hand over access.

Step 13 — After the rental (*automated*) The customer receives a short follow-up message. The booking is closed in the system and the room becomes available for new requests automatically.

Page 3 — Team Roles & Why This Works

Allusion's role in this system is to orchestrate, not to operate. The team approves requests, and the team receives guests. That is essentially the full extent of their involvement. Every other step — communication, invoicing, payments, calendar management, reminders, and task assignments — is handled automatically by the system.

Customer / Renter Submits a request online, pays if approved, and receives everything they need automatically. They do not need to call or email anyone. If they pay and show up on time, they get access. If they do not pay, they do not get in. If they do not show up, that is their responsibility.

Allusion Administrator The person who receives booking requests and makes the approval decision. This is a brief, occasional task — not a daily job. They also have a full overview of all upcoming and past bookings at any time.

Operations / Access Contact Receives automatic task notifications when a booking is confirmed. Knows exactly when to be available, what to prepare, and what the customer needs. Does not need to ask for any information — it is all sent automatically.

Finance Has no manual work to do in the day-to-day flow. Invoices are generated automatically and payments are collected online. However, for cancellations and refunds, Allusion is notified in a clear inbox or dashboard — showing exactly what happened, what the customer is owed if anything, and what action is needed. This keeps the finance person in control of money movements without being involved in every booking. The tools being considered for this are Odoo, which can handle invoicing and financial tracking in one place, and Stripe, which handles online payments and refunds reliably. The final choice between them — or a combination of both — will be decided based on what fits Allusion's workflow best.

Why This Approach

Allusion has a valuable space that generates nothing while it sits empty. With this system, that space becomes a source of income with almost no operational overhead. The team does not need to hire someone to manage bookings. They do not need to be available around the clock. They simply check a notification, make a quick decision, and the system handles the rest.

The tools used are modern, reliable, and widely used by businesses across Europe. For payments and invoicing, two strong options are being evaluated: **Stripe**, which is simple, widely trusted, and handles online payments and automatic refunds with minimal setup, and **Odoo**, which is a more complete business tool that can manage invoices, payments, and financial records all in one place. Both can be highly automated. The right choice — or a combination of both — will be confirmed once we have a clearer picture of how Allusion wants to handle its finances and what level of oversight they prefer.

This is not a complex IT project. It is a practical, lean solution that turns an empty room into a working business asset.

Document prepared for internal review — all workflows and responsibilities are subject to change based on feedback from the Allusion team.